

Signal of the week

NHTSA orders Tesla to justify Cybercab self-certification by 30 September

NHTSA issued a Special Order on 10 September under Audit Query AQ26002, demanding sworn answers to 21 questions on how Tesla self-certified the no-wheel, no-pedal Cybercab as FMVSS-compliant. Around 1,000 units operate in Austin; responses were due 30 September 2026.

Why it matters — First formal US challenge to self-certification of a purpose-built driverless vehicle already carrying paying riders.

Sources: NHTSA (2026-09-30)

Where the activity was

	SDV	Connect- ivity	AI	Data mgmt	Digital twins	Regu- latory	Cyber- security	Quality	Telematics services
Automotive	4	1	0	1	0	3	1	3	1
Robotics / AV	1	0	1	0	0	4	1	2	0
Fleets	1	2	2	2	0	2	0	1	4
Energy	1	2	0	0	0	3	1	1	1
Agri / industrial	1	0	1	1	1	1	1	1	0

Qualifying items this week (score ≥ 6), by theme: none 1-2 3-5 6+

The read-across

Regulators dominated the week. NHTSA activity around Tesla's Cybercab self-certification, Zoox's robotaxi exemption, Waymo's flooded-road OTA recall, and the Recalls Next notice signals a US framework being rewritten around driverless vehicles.

Connectivity and cyber signals reinforced each other. Kigen's SGP.32 v1.3 eSIM certification, the Iridium–Deutsche Telekom–Toyota NB-IoT satellite demonstration, and Thales's five-operator SGP.32 rollout show the eSIM-plus-NTN stack reaching commercial readiness.

75
candidates screened

15
items featured

7
deals logged

● Automotive OEMs

Quality SDV Regulatory

Volkswagen recalls 49,958 MY2025 Tiguan over BCM software that can stall engine

NHTSA campaign 26V587 covers 49,958 MY2025 Tiguan whose Body Control Module mishandles ECC errors, resetting mid-drive and disabling ignition, exterior lights, airbags and rearview camera. Dealers will reflash to BCM version 0326; owner letters follow on 6 November 2026.

So what — Named account faces a software-defect recall touching airbags and drivetrain, remediated only in-workshop.

NHTSA, 2026-09-25

Connectivity Cybersecurity SDV

Kigen automotive eSIM is first certified to GSMA SGP.32 v1.3

Arm's Kigen unit achieved GSMA eUICC Security Assurance certification for an automotive eSIM on Infineon's TEGRION SLI22, the first to SGP.32 v1.3 with emergency-profile and post-quantum mitigations. OEM sampling in MFF2 and GSMA interoperability testing both begin October 2026.

So what — Sets the reference security bar competitors must match to sell SGP.32 automotive eSIMs to long-life fleets.

Media OutReach Newswire, 2026-09-29

Regulatory Data mgmt Telematics services

EU Data Act one year on: OEM APIs live, fleet data access nearing commodity

A September 2026 Optivo analysis found all major automotive groups completed API infrastructure between October 2025 and March 2026 to share telematics data with third parties under Regulation (EU) 2023/2854.

So what — Confirms the EU has moved from mandate to live infrastructure, shifting negotiating power to fleet operators.

Optivo Logistics, 2026-09-08

● Robotics and autonomous vehicles

Regulatory Cybersecurity

FCC adds foreign humanoid and quadruped robots to Covered List

FCC Public Notice DA 26-786 added foreign-produced networked robots over 4.4 lb to the Covered List on 28 July 2026, citing remote-takeover and supply-chain risks. New foreign models require conditional approval; previously authorised units are grandfathered through 2029.

So what — Ties robotics market access in the US to cybersecurity and origin, reshaping OEM sourcing decisions.

FCC, 2026-07-28

Regulatory Quality

NHTSA grants Zoox first commercial exemption for a purpose-built robotaxi

NHTSA granted Zoox a temporary exemption allowing up to 2,500 purpose-built robotaxis annually for two years, the first for a driverless vehicle without conventional controls. The agency also signalled FMVSS updates and is developing National Competency Standards for ADS-equipped vehicles.

So what — Creates a US legal route to scale non-conventional robotaxis before FMVSS is rewritten.

Advocates for Highway and Auto Safety citing NHTSA, 2026-07-30

Regulatory AI

China's CSRC applies three-criteria guidance to cool humanoid-robot IPO pipeline

China's securities regulator informally told humanoid-robot IPO applicants they must demonstrate sustainable revenue, a three-year loss-narrowing forecast and ownership of core technology. The guidance followed Unitree's Shanghai debut, which surged nearly 500% before retreating sharply.

So what — Raises the listing bar for at least two dozen embodied-AI companies filed in Hong Kong and Shanghai.

CNBC, 2026-09-29

● Fleets

Connectivity Telematics services

Iridium, Deutsche Telekom IoT and Toyota send first NB-IoT satellite voice message

On 10 September 2026, Iridium and Deutsche Telekom IoT demonstrated a standards-based NB-IoT voice message from a Toyota vehicle via Iridium LEO satellites, completing a global roaming agreement. Commercial availability for automotive and logistics customers is planned for Q4 2026.

So what — Named-account OEM validates a live NB-IoT NTN path for connected-vehicle services beyond cellular coverage.

Iridium newsroom, 2026-09-10

Connectivity Regulatory Telematics services

Thales and four APAC operators deploy multi-network IoT eSIM using SGP.32

Thales, Singtel, Optus, AIS and Globe Telecom launched a multi-operator IoT eSIM network based on GSMA SGP.32, letting connected vehicles and fleet devices switch between participating networks across borders without SIM replacement. The rollout targets the automotive and commercial-fleet segment.

So what — First live cross-border SGP.32 deployment in Asia-Pacific for vehicle and fleet devices.

PaveInsight, 2026-09-28

Telematics services Data mgmt AI

GM launches OnStar Fleet Intelligence platform

On 30 September 2026 GM unveiled OnStar Fleet Intelligence, a centralised service integrating factory-embedded vehicle data with connected services to optimise asset utilisation, risk and operating cost for fleet managers. The launch extends OnStar's B2B position against aftermarket TSPs.

So what — Named-account OEM pushes deeper into fleet telematics using its own embedded data as the baseline product.

PR Newswire via GuruFocus, 2026-09-30

● Energy

Regulatory Connectivity Telematics services

Volkswagen and Elli set Q4 2026 launch of integrated V2G package in Germany

Volkswagen and energy subsidiary Elli confirmed a Q4 2026 German launch of a bundled V2G offer combining an EV, bidirectional charger, smart meter, app and tariff, letting customers export stored power for revenue. Pre-registration opened June 2026.

So what — First major OEM to sell V2G as a single retail bundle rather than a pilot, standardising the customer journey.

Volkswagen Group Newsroom, 2026-09-29

Quality SDV

Toyota recalls 8,521 2026 C-HR EVs for BEV ECU software allowing battery overcharge

NHTSA recall 26V570000 covers 8,521 MY2026 Toyota C-HR EVs built February–July 2026. A Denso ECU software flaw can cause regenerative braking to overcharge the traction battery and trigger a full drive shutdown.

So what — Named-account EV recall centres on battery-management software, a growing category of electric-drive defects.

NHTSA via rswebsols.com, 2026-09-02

Regulatory Connectivity

IEA publishes first standalone V2G report finding 75% cut in transformer overloads

The IEA released its first dedicated V2G report on 25 September 2026, concluding bidirectional charging could prevent three-quarters of distribution-transformer overloads by 2050 versus uncontrolled charging, based on San Francisco modelling. Inconsistent standards are the main commercial barrier.

So what — Puts V2G on the agenda of grid regulators worldwide with a concrete infrastructure-avoidance number.

IEA via GCN, 2026-09-25

● Agri and industrial OEMs

AI SDV Digital twins Data mgmt

Komatsu and EARTHRAIN partner with AIM Intelligent Machines on autonomous dozers and excavators

Komatsu and subsidiary EARTHRAIN announced a partnership with AIM Intelligent Machines to deliver autonomous bulldozers and excavators in the US and Japan, integrating AIM's physical-AI stack with Komatsu's Smart Construction platform. US deployment is underway; Japan follows in 2027.

So what — Named agri/industrial account commits to a physical-AI autonomy stack across two flagship machine categories.

Power Progress, 2026-08-03

Cybersecurity Quality Regulatory

NMFTA reveals Bendix EC80 truck brake recall silently patched remote code execution flaws

At Black Hat USA 2026, NMFTA researchers revealed that a 2024 Bendix EC80 brake controller recall had also addressed cyber vulnerabilities, including a remotely exploitable code-execution flaw and a hardcoded password capable of disabling traction control.

So what — Raises questions about transparency when safety recalls also carry undisclosed cybersecurity remediations.

SecurityWeek, 2026-08-07

● Deals and partnerships logged this week

Who	With	What	Domain	Relevance
Arm Kigen	Infineon	SGP.32 v1.3 automotive eSIM certified by GSMA	Automotive	Competitive
Volkswagen	Elli	Integrated V2G retail bundle for Germany	Energy	Prospect
Iridium	Deutsche Telekom IoT	Global NB-IoT NTN roaming agreement with Toyota demo	Fleets	Competitive
Thales	Singtel, Optus, AIS, Globe Telecom	Multi-operator SGP.32 IoT eSIM network for vehicles	Fleets	Competitive
Komatsu	AIM Intelligent Machines	Autonomy partnership for dozers and excavators in US and Japan	Agri / industrial	Customer
General Motors	OnStar	OnStar Fleet Intelligence platform launch	Fleets	Customer
Stellantis	Mobilisights Connect	Expanded B2B connected-vehicle data offer	Fleets	Competitive

Method: 75 candidates screened across ~60 sources for the week; items scored 0–10 on significance, novelty and relevance; threshold 6. Themes: SDV, connectivity, AI, data management, digital twins, regulatory framework, cybersecurity, quality and telematics services. Full source list in editions/ on GitHub.